Surge in EV demand blows past German government's subsidy forecasts

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【要点】

・ドイツの電動車補助金制度の予算が予想より早く枯渇し、2029年までの予定が2027年末までに終わる可能性がある。

・電動車の購入申請が予想を大幅に上回っており、2026年の支出が10億ユーロに達する見込みで、2027年の予算不足は17億ユーロになると予想されている。

・ドイツでは10月に電動車新規登録が記録的な37%の市場シェアに達しており、補助金による需要増が大きな要因とされている。

・政府は補助金受給額をまだ増額しない方針だが、購入希望者に対して2027年末までは資金が確保されていると保証している。

・自動車専門家は補助金が終了すると登録数が急減する可能性を指摘しており、2024年の類似の事例を参考としている。

【メール原文】

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Surge in EV demand blows past German government's subsidy forecasts
By Karsten Siebel · Nov 10, 2026, 5:24 PM · View in your browser

BERLIN — Germany's electric vehicle subsidy scheme is running out of money far faster than the government anticipated.

The program was supposed to last until 2029, but at the current rate of spending its entire €2.7 billion budget could be gone by the end of 2027, according to a document prepared for final negotiations on Germany's 2027 federal budget and seen by WELT, a sister publication of POLITICO in the Axel Springer Group.

"The EV subsidy scheme is developing far more dynamically than anticipated when it was designed and its funding requirements were originally calculated," the document states.

The budget allocation is being adjusted, but "without changing the overall size of the program."

According to government estimates, the funding is enough to subsidize around 800,000 vehicles. Buyers can receive government grants of up to €6,000 per vehicle.

In early October, Germany's BAFA export control agency, which administers the scheme, said it had already approved 100,000 applications and paid out more than €430 million.

If applications continue at the same pace, spending could reach €1 billion in 2026. The federal budget originally earmarked just €803 million for the scheme in 2027, but the government now expects to pay out €1.7 billion — draining the fund.

So far, the government has given no indication of whether it intends to put more cash into the program.

Environment Minister Carsten Schneider said in October that demand had exceeded all expectations. At the same time, he sought to reassure prospective buyers that there is enough money in the program to continue funding through 2027.

“Anyone who decides to buy a battery-electric vehicle now and meets the eligibility criteria need not worry about next year either,” Schneider told Auto Motor Sport magazine.

However, the application process does pose risks for car buyers facing long delivery times. Government subsidies are not reserved when customers place an order at a dealership, but are only granted once the vehicle has been registered for the first time.

Electric vehicle sales are soaring in Germany. More than 94,000 new EVs were registered in October for a record market share of 37%, according to the Federal Motor Transport Authority .

“The market is booming — but it is booming primarily because of the subsidy,” Constantin Gall, an automotive expert at the EY consultancy, told the AFP news agency.

The real test, he said, would come when the money runs out. “I expect electric vehicle registrations to fall sharply again, just as they did in 2024 after the subsidy was discontinued in December 2023.”

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